Your return-to-run plan

A 10-week walk-run plan from your first run back to 8 km of non-stop running.

Name _____ Physiotherapist _____ Start date _____

Before you start (your physio will check these)

- ☐ Your injury is pain-free (or at an agreed low, steady level) in everyday activity.
- ☐ You can walk briskly for 30 minutes without pain.
- ☐ You can pass the test your physio sets for your injury (for example, single-leg hops or calf raises) without pain.
- ☐ You have had several pain-free days in a row.

The 3/10 pain rule

- On a scale of 0 (no pain) to 10 (worst pain imaginable), keep pain at **3/10 or below** while you run.
- Pain should settle within 24 hours, and you should be **no worse the next morning**.
- Move to the next session only if the last one met both rules.
- If it didn't, **repeat the previous session** next time. Don't push through.
- If the same session fails twice, or pain keeps rising, stop running and contact your physiotherapist.

How to run each session

- **4 sessions a week**, with a rest day after most runs. One pair of back-to-back days a week is fine (for example Monday, Wednesday, Friday and Saturday).
- Warm up with 5 minutes of brisk walking, and walk for 5 minutes to cool down.
- Run at an **easy pace**: you should be able to talk in full sentences. Repeat the run / walk pattern until you have covered the distance. Speed doesn't matter.
- Stay on **flat, even ground** (path, track or treadmill). No hills, speed work or trails until your physio says so.
- Keep doing your strengthening exercises on non-running days. If your physio has given you a running cue, such as a quicker step rate, use it from session 1.
- Missed a few days? Repeat the last session you completed rather than skipping ahead. Each new week starts a little easier on purpose.

Week 1 Walk-run introduction

3 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
1	**Run 1 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
2	**Run 2 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
3	**Run 3 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
4	**Run 5 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐

Week 2 Longer run intervals

3 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
5	**Run 3 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
6	**Run 5 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
7	**Run 8 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
8	**Run 10 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐

Week 3 Consolidating

3 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
9	**Run 8 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
10	**Run 10 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
11	**Run 10 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐
12	**Run 12 min**, walk 1 min	**3 km**	☐

Week 4 Up to 5 km

5 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
13	**Run 3 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
14	**Run 5 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
15	**Run 8 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
16	**Run 10 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐

Week 5 Longer intervals

5 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
17	**Run 8 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
18	**Run 10 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
19	**Run 13 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
20	**Run 15 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐

Week 6 Nearly continuous

5 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
21	**Run 10 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
22	**Run 15 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
23	**Run 20 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
24	**Run 15 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐

Week 7 5 km non-stop

5 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
25	**Run 15 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
26	**Run 20 min**, walk 1 min	**5 km**	☐
27	**Run non-stop**	**5 km**	☐
28	**Run non-stop**	**5 km**	☐

Week 8 Building to 6 km

5–6 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
29	**Run 15 min**, walk 1 min	**6 km**	☐
30	**Run 20 min**, walk 1 min	**6 km**	☐
31	**Run non-stop**	**5 km**	☐
32	**Run non-stop**	**6 km**	☐

Week 9 Building to 7 km

6–7 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
33	**Run 20 min**, walk 1 min	**7 km**	☐
34	**Run non-stop**	**6 km**	☐
35	**Run non-stop**	**7 km**	☐
36	**Run non-stop**	**7 km**	☐

Week 10 8 km non-stop

7–8 km sessions

SESSION	RUN / WALK	DISTANCE	DONE
37	**Run 20 min**, walk 1 min	**8 km**	☐
38	**Run non-stop**	**7 km**	☐
39	**Run 30 min**, walk 1 min	**8 km**	☐
40	**Run non-stop**	**8 km**	☐

After week 10: what comes next

1. Build volume
Add running time or an extra run gradually, at easy pace. Avoid big jumps from one week to the next.

2. Add speed, hills and terrain
One new thing at a time, once your normal running volume feels comfortable.

3. Back to full training
Return to your usual training and goals, and keep a strength session in your week.

Your physiotherapist may change this plan to suit you; follow their advice over this sheet. Based on the return-to-run criteria and progression in Module 5 (5.5–5.6) of the Running Gait Analysis course. · Core Learning